

The Emacs Newsreader

Elfeed and Gnus are Web feed news readers for Emacs. In this article in the GNU Emacs series, we will learn how to use GNU Emacs as a news reader.



Elfeed is an Emacs Web feed reader that is extensible and supports both Atom and RSS feeds. It has been written by Christopher Wellons.

Installation

We shall use Milkypostman's Emacs Lisp Package Archive (MELPA) to install Elfeed. Create an initial GNU Emacs start-up file that contains the following:

```
(require 'package) ;; You might already have this line
(add-to-list 'package-archives
  '("melpa" . "https://melpa.org/packages/"))

(when (< emacs-major-version 24)
  ;; For important compatibility libraries like cl-lib
  (add-to-list 'package-archives
    '("gnu" . "http://elpa.gnu.org/packages/")))
(package-initialize) ;; You might already have this line
```

The above code snippet has been taken from the MELPA project documentation website <http://melpa.org/#/getting-started>, and has been tested on GNU Emacs 24.5.2.

You can now start GNU Emacs using the following command:

```
$ emacs -Q -l ~/elfeed-start.el
```

You can obtain the list of available packages using M-x list-packages, which will search the *melpa.org* and *elpa.gnu.org* repositories. You can search for 'elfeed' in this buffer, and select the same for installation by pressing the 'i' key. To actually install the package, press the 'x' (execute) key, and Elfeed will be installed in the `~/emacs.d/elpa` directory.

Configuration

You can create a shortcut to start Elfeed using the following